

Prayers for our World and the Church

including Prayer of Confession

5th July 2026

Psalm 8:1, 4 [1] *O Lord, our Lord, How majestic is Your Name in all the earth,
Who have displayed Your splendor above the heavens!*
[4-5] *What is man that You take thought of him, And the son of man that You care for him?
Yet You have made him a little lower than Yourself And You crown him with glory and majesty!*

As we come today to both the Word and the Sacrament, commemorating the death and resurrection of our Lord and Saviour, let us pray together, to acknowledge God's greatness, to confess our imperfection and need of Jesus' sacrifice, and to bring our requests to Him Who alone is able to bring lasting change, according to His purposes for the world and for us within it.

Adoration

O Lord, our Lord, indeed, we come into Your Presence to declare "How majestic is Your Name in all the earth!" Creator of all that is, we Your creatures come before You because You are merciful, faithful and righteous. From everlasting to everlasting, You alone are God, all-powerful, all-seeing, all-holy and altogether just! And You have made man to be second in command of this Earth, under Your overall sovereignty.

Confession

Despite that glorious calling, in Adam, we sinned and fell short, so that if we were to rely on Your justice, we would be lost, for we would not seek You or put our trust in You. Rather, we would want to rule ourselves and this world in Your place. But because You are all-loving, and graciously merciful, we are not destroyed. We look back upon our week and confess the times when we have failed, and have brought down the Name of Jesus. We are ashamed of our thoughts, words and deeds and freely confess them to You now.

Thanksgiving

We thank You now for Your promise that if we confess our sins, You are faithful and just to forgive all our unrighteousness. We thank You that You have not abandoned us, but rescued us. We thank You for the special grace of salvation: while we were still sinners, Jesus came as the Sinless, Son of God and Son of Man to take our place, suffer the penalty which we deserved, to die in our stead so we could go free. We thank You that You have lifted up the light of Your face upon us. We thank You that we now have joy in our hearts, and peace in our relationship with You.

Supplication: The Wider World... and the wider Church

In the wider world, we continue to pray for the war-torn regions and for the people caught in the conflicts. We pray also for believers suffering persecution in silence, because Your church is deemed to be "not newsworthy." We ask You to strengthen and provide for Your people in churches nearby, who seek to meet the needs of the escaping refugees.

Supplication: Ashburton

Here in Ashburton we pray for Dong Choi as he preaches Your Word, and we pray for our own understanding as we listen. May we be transformed by the renewing of our minds so that Your living Word goes deep into our hearts. Holy Spirit, we pray that You would change us so that we live our lives more and more in conformity to Your Word. We pray that our fellowship continues to grow stronger each week. We pray for Your wisdom and guidance in our congregational meeting, as we seek Your servant leader to lead the work here.

Finally, we pray for ourselves in the service of the Kingdom. We thank You that we are a part of the work of spreading the Good News, and members of the worldwide Body of Christ. May we grow to show the character of our Risen Lord so well that others will see Him rather than us.

In Jesus Mighty Name we pray all these things, Amen.